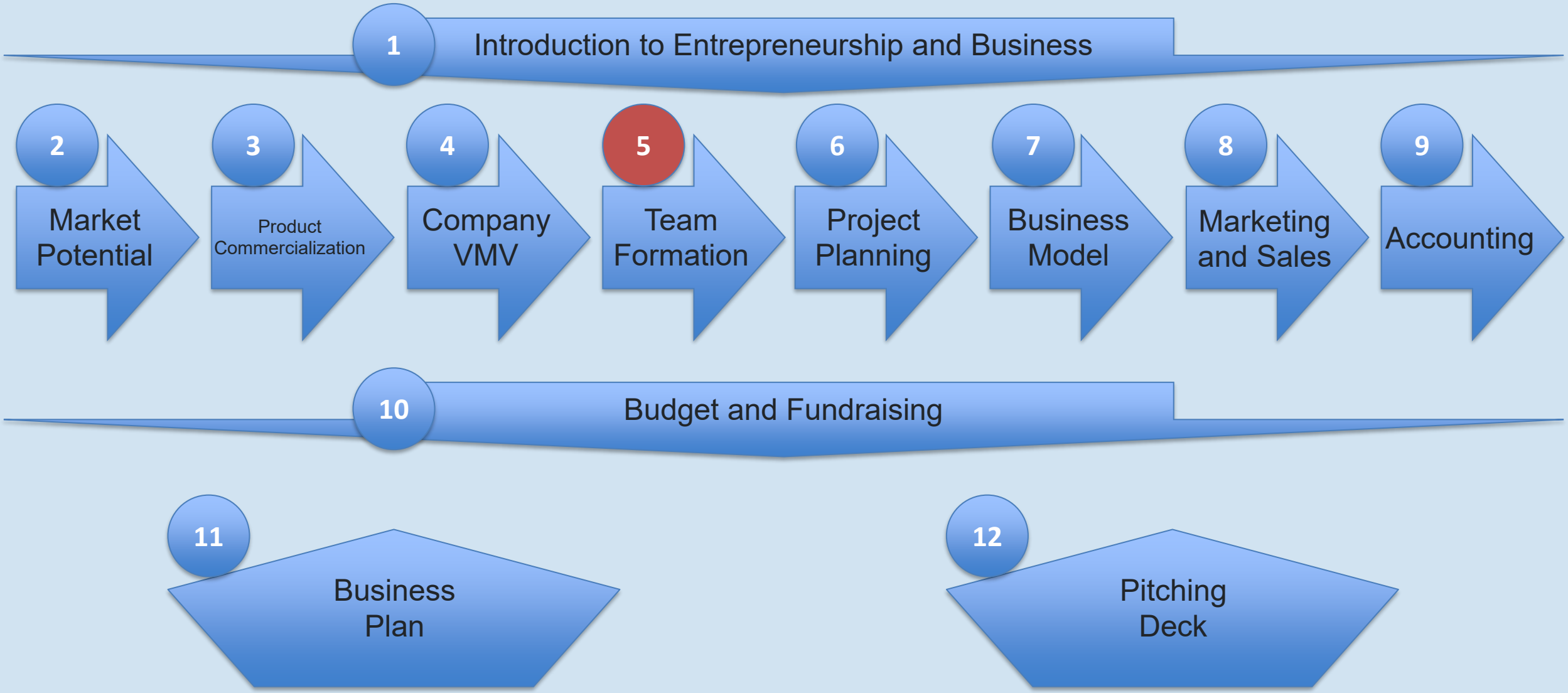
Team Formation and Value Proposition

Ir Prof Alan Lam, JP



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Outline of the Course



Chapter 1: Team Formation of a Successful Startup

Ir Prof Alan Lam, JP

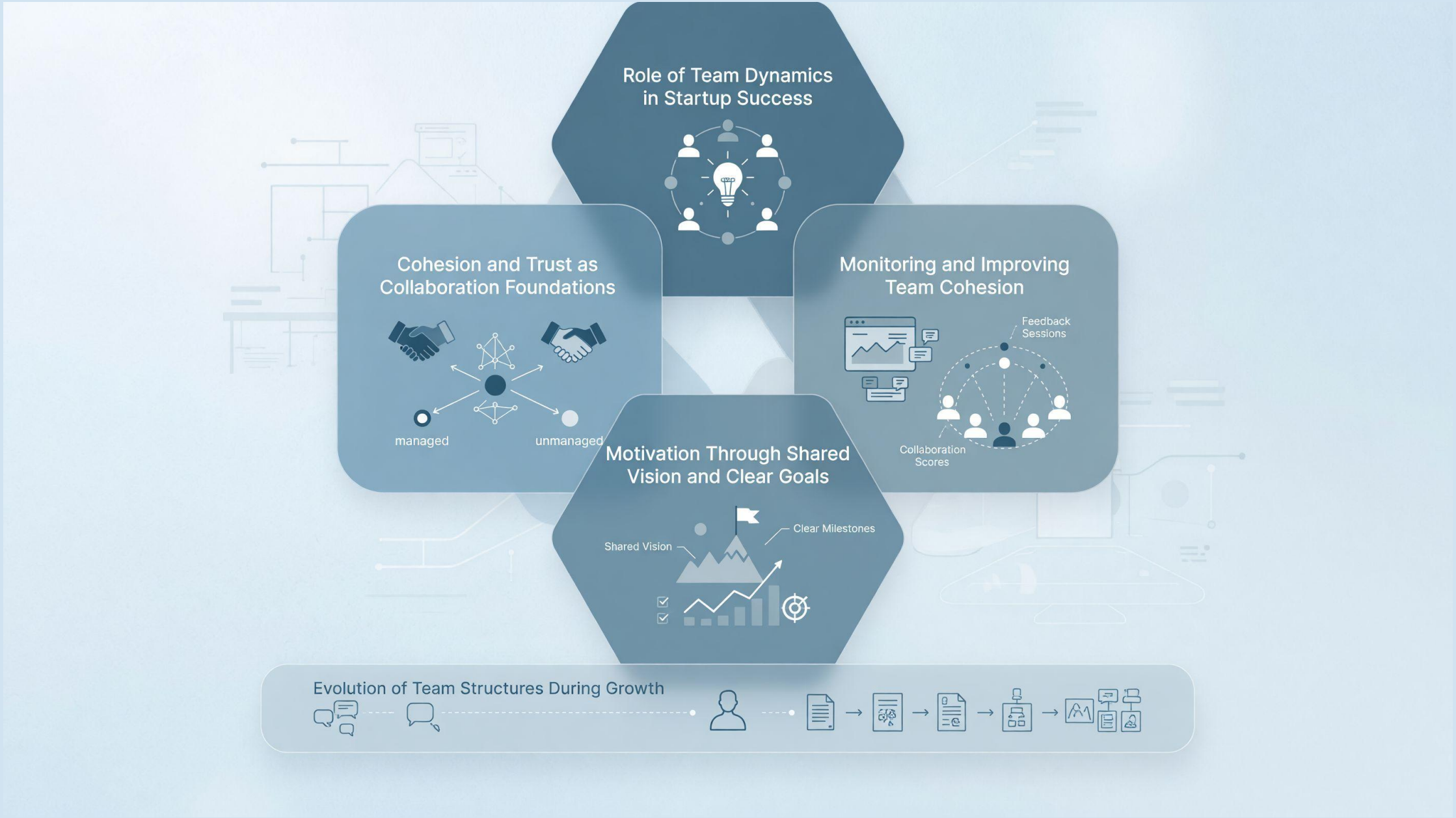


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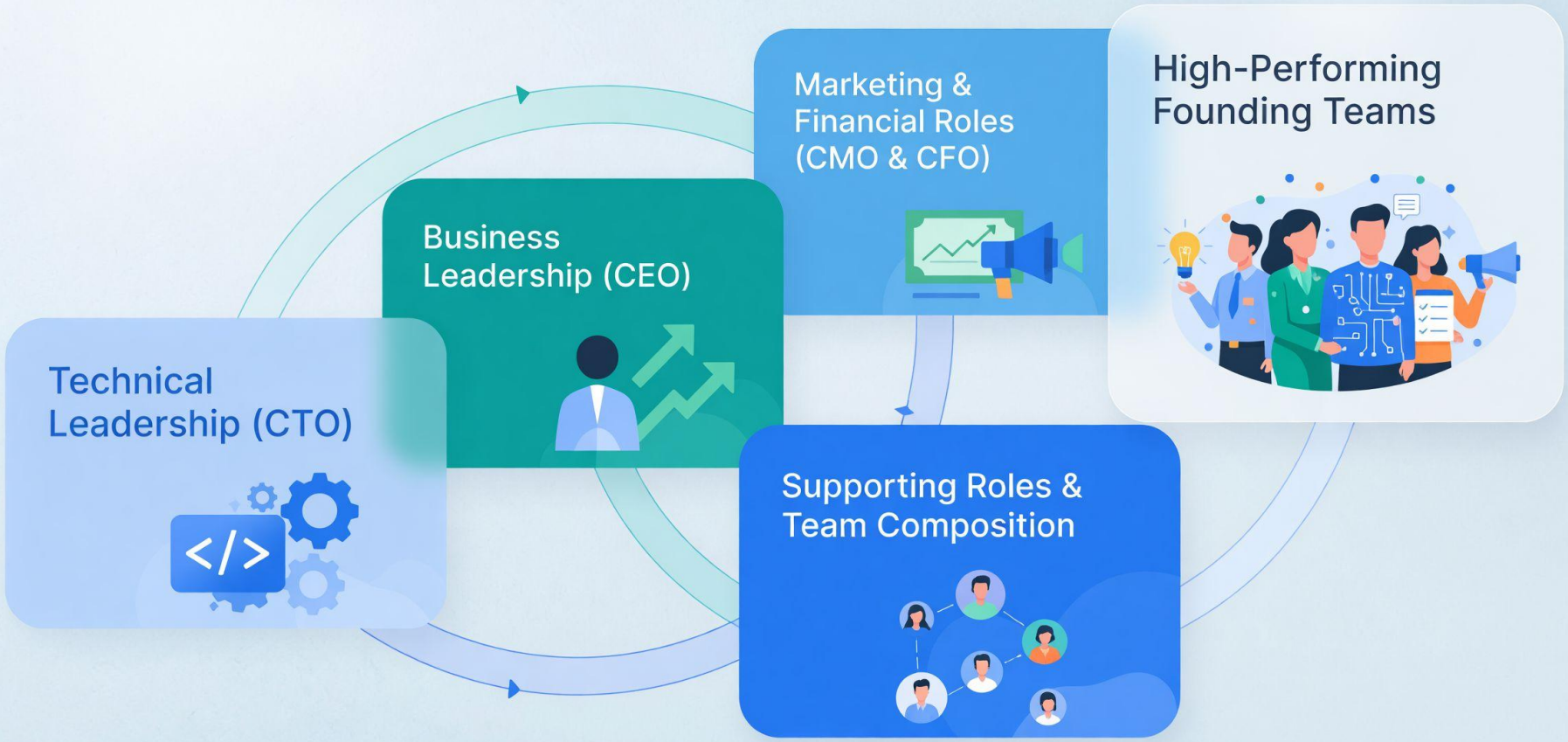
Defining a Successful Startup Team



Understanding Team Dynamics



Identifying Key Roles in Tech Startups



Impact of Diversity on Startup Success

Multifaceted Diversity
Beyond Demographics



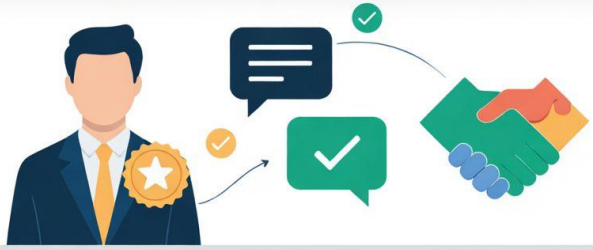
Diversity Drives Innovation
& Market Performance



Positive Impact on
Morale & Retention



Leadership & Conflict
Resolution Enable Success



Team Size Optimization

Performance Impact of Team Size



Agility & Speed vs. Skill Diversity & Decision Speed

Coordination Complexity Model



Communication Links (Channels) Grow Quadratically



Ideal Range: 3 to 7 members



Balanced Team Size Strategy

Small Core Teams





Scale Judiciously: Balance Agility & Coordination

Practical Scaling Experience



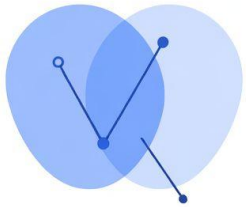
Jaz Chana



Real-World Scaling — Communication Clarity & Defined Roles

Complementary Skill Sets

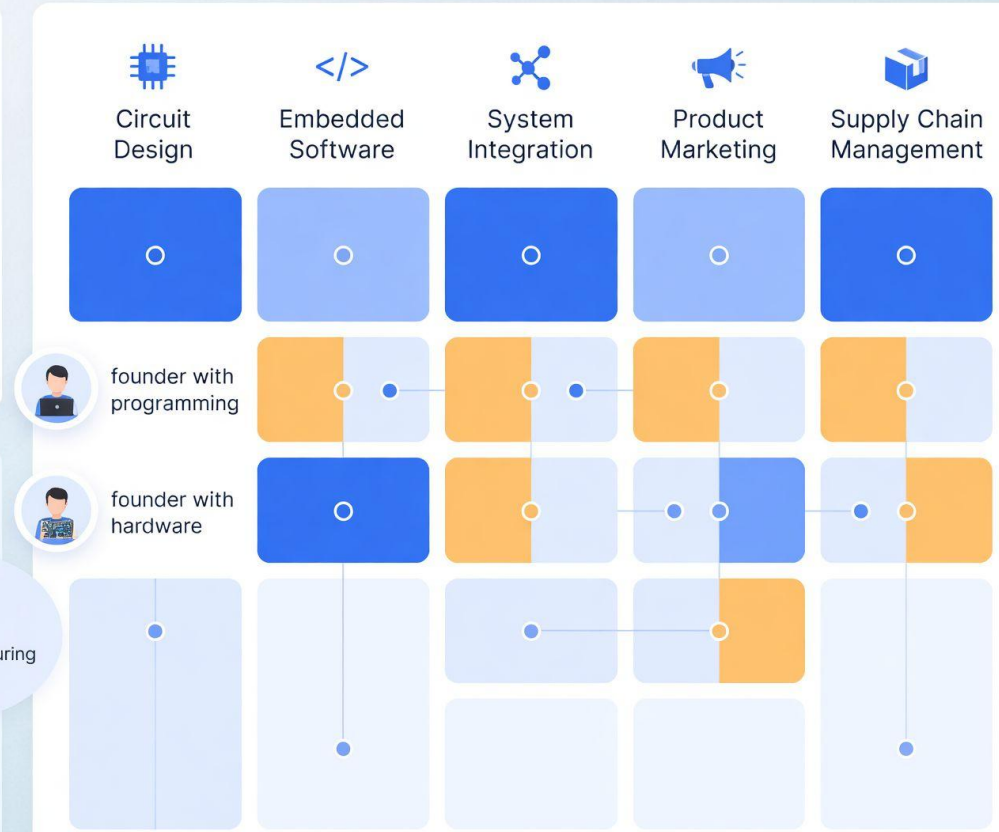
Synergistic Effect of Complementery Skills



Mutually Enhancing Talents

Practical IoT Startup Example





Critical Gap Analysis & Risk

Risk: Supply Chain Gap
→ Delays & Costs

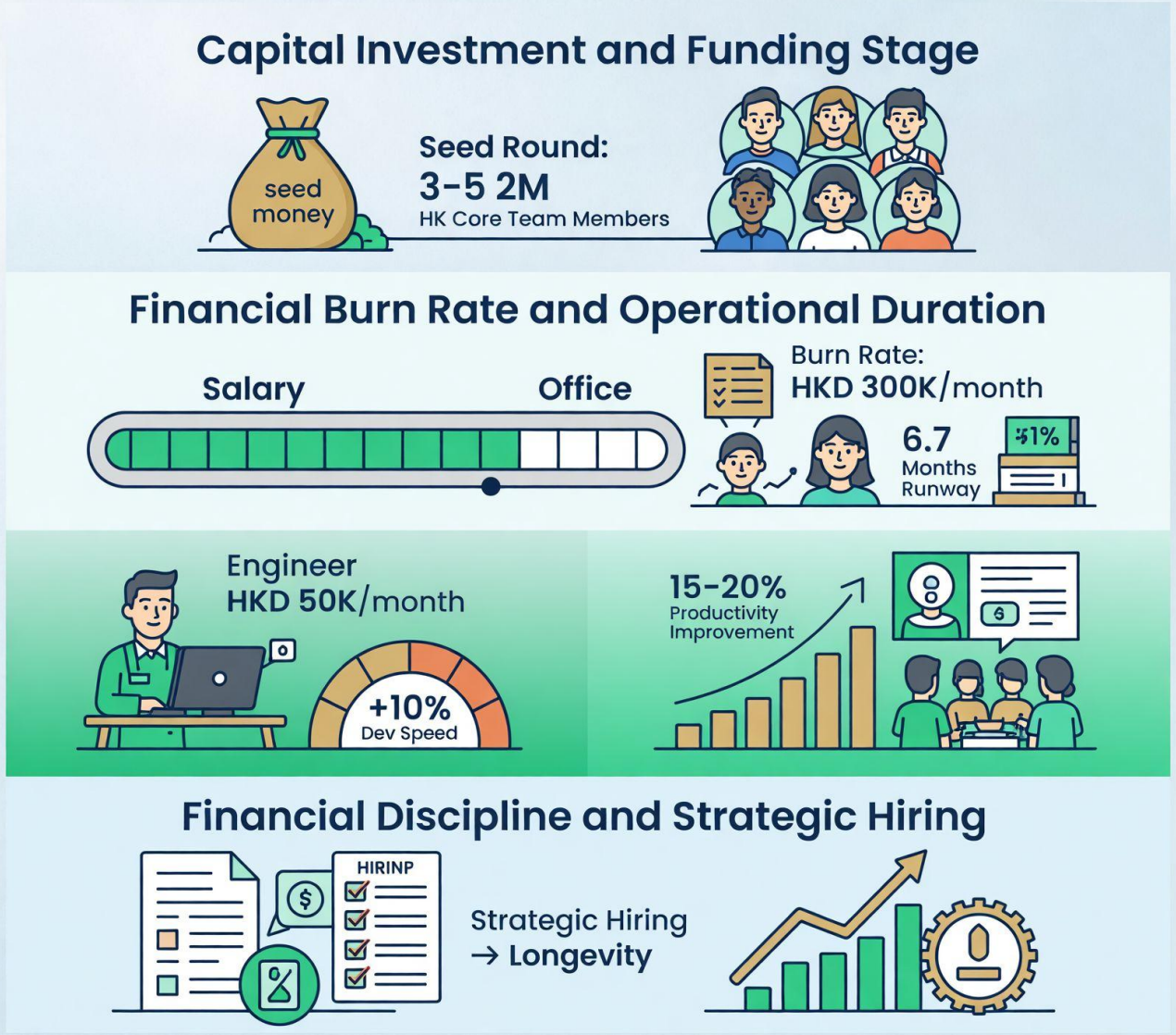


Market Evidence

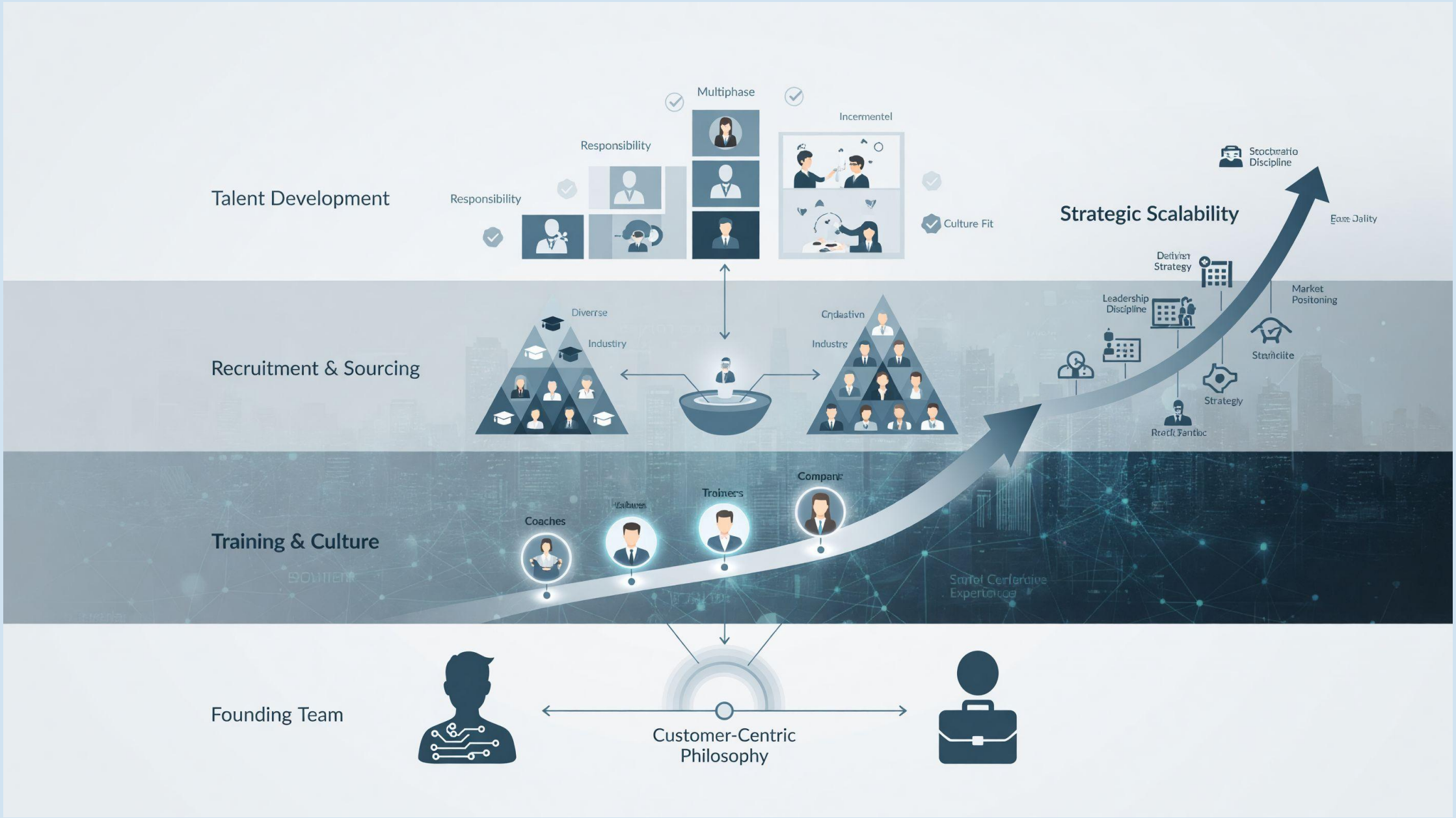
Balanced Tech & Business Teams



Financial Metrics Impacting Team Formation

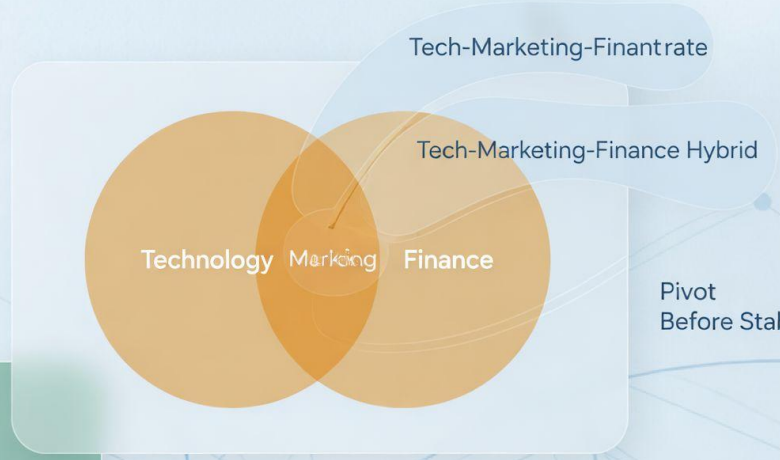


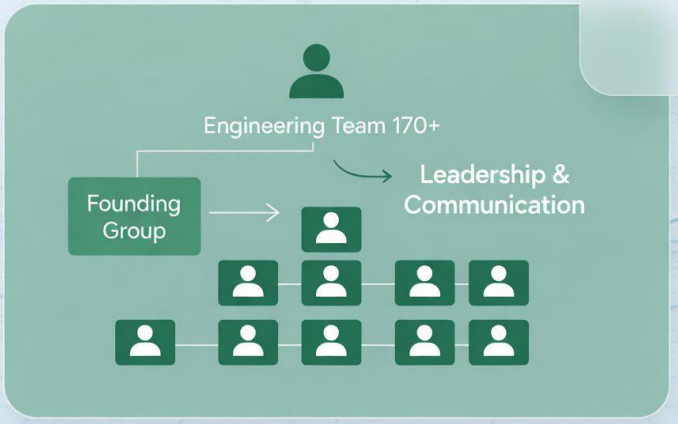
Case Study: Team Formation in High-value Startups

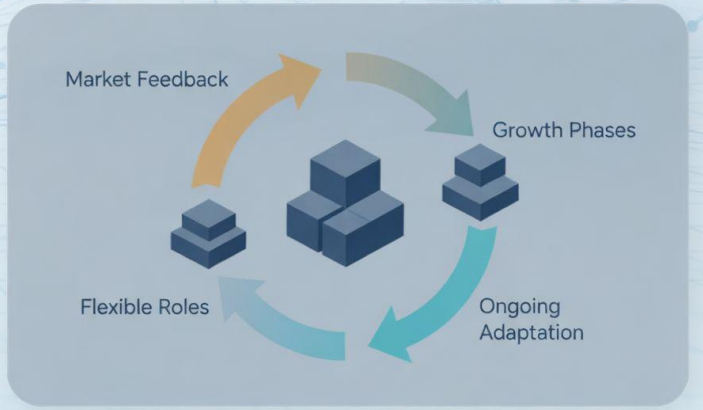


Case Studies of Startup Teams

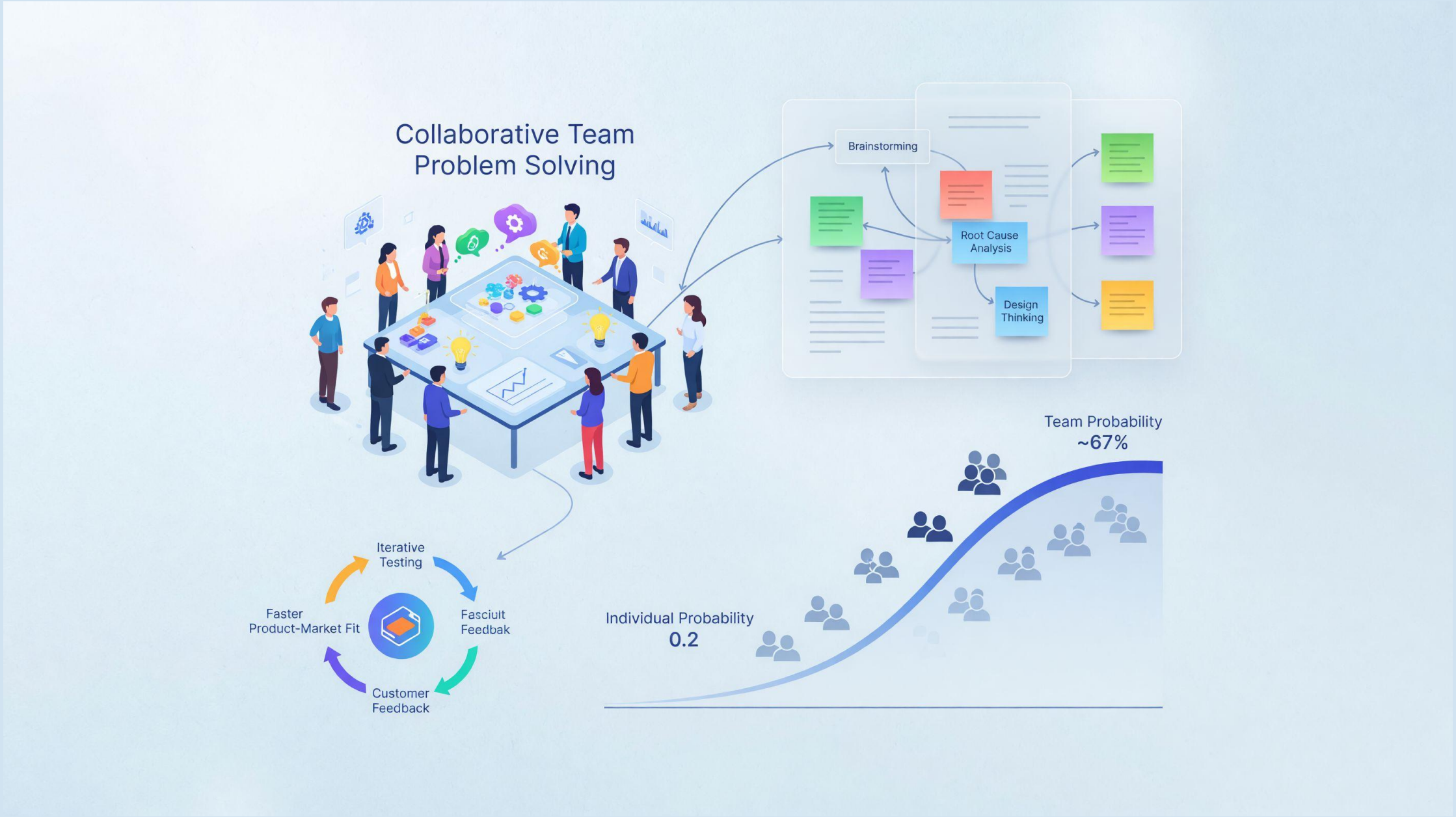








Problem Solving with Team-based Approaches



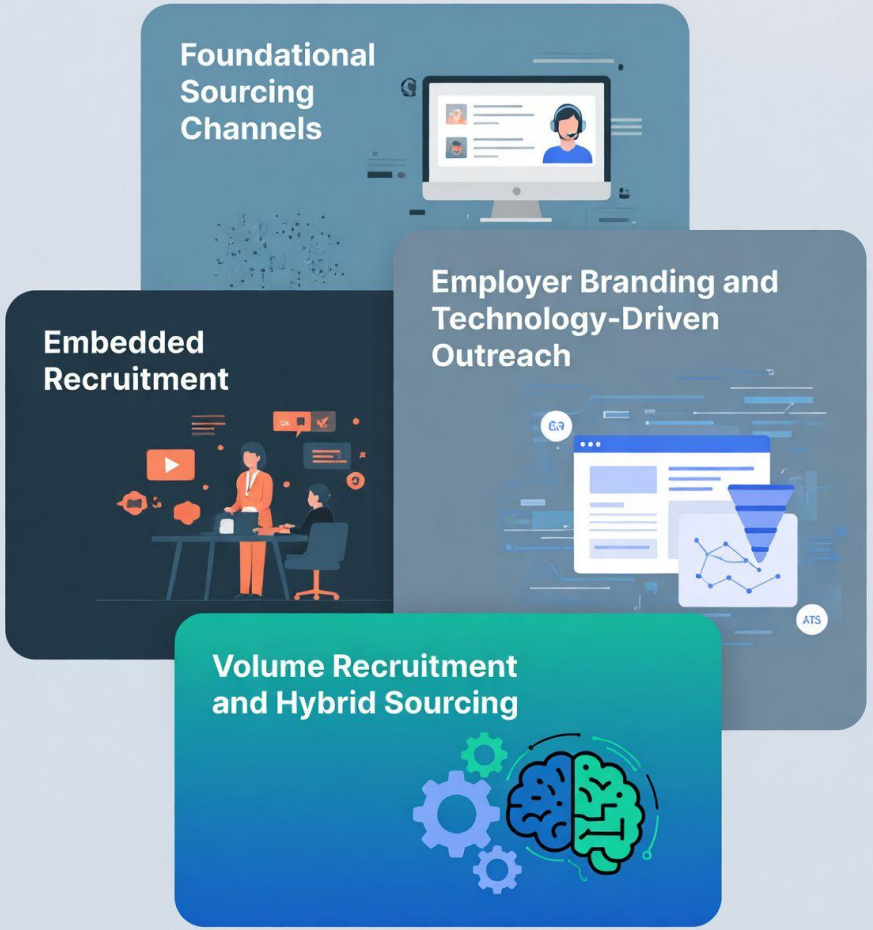
Chapter 2: Talent Recruitment Strategies for Startup

Ir Prof Alan Lam, JP



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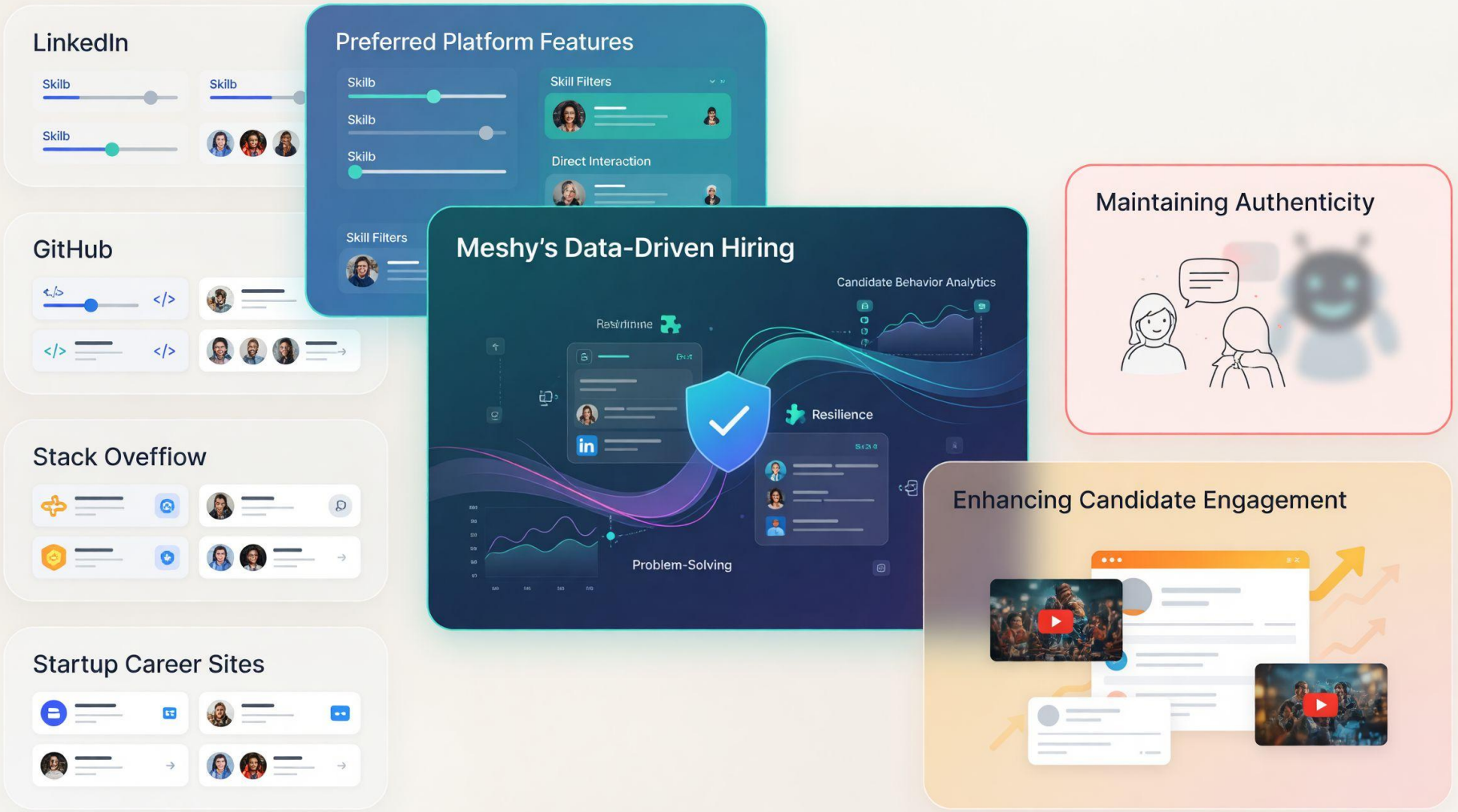
Source of Recruitment



Strategic Channel Integration for Effectiveness

Optimized Reach · Cost Efficiency · Candidate Rigor

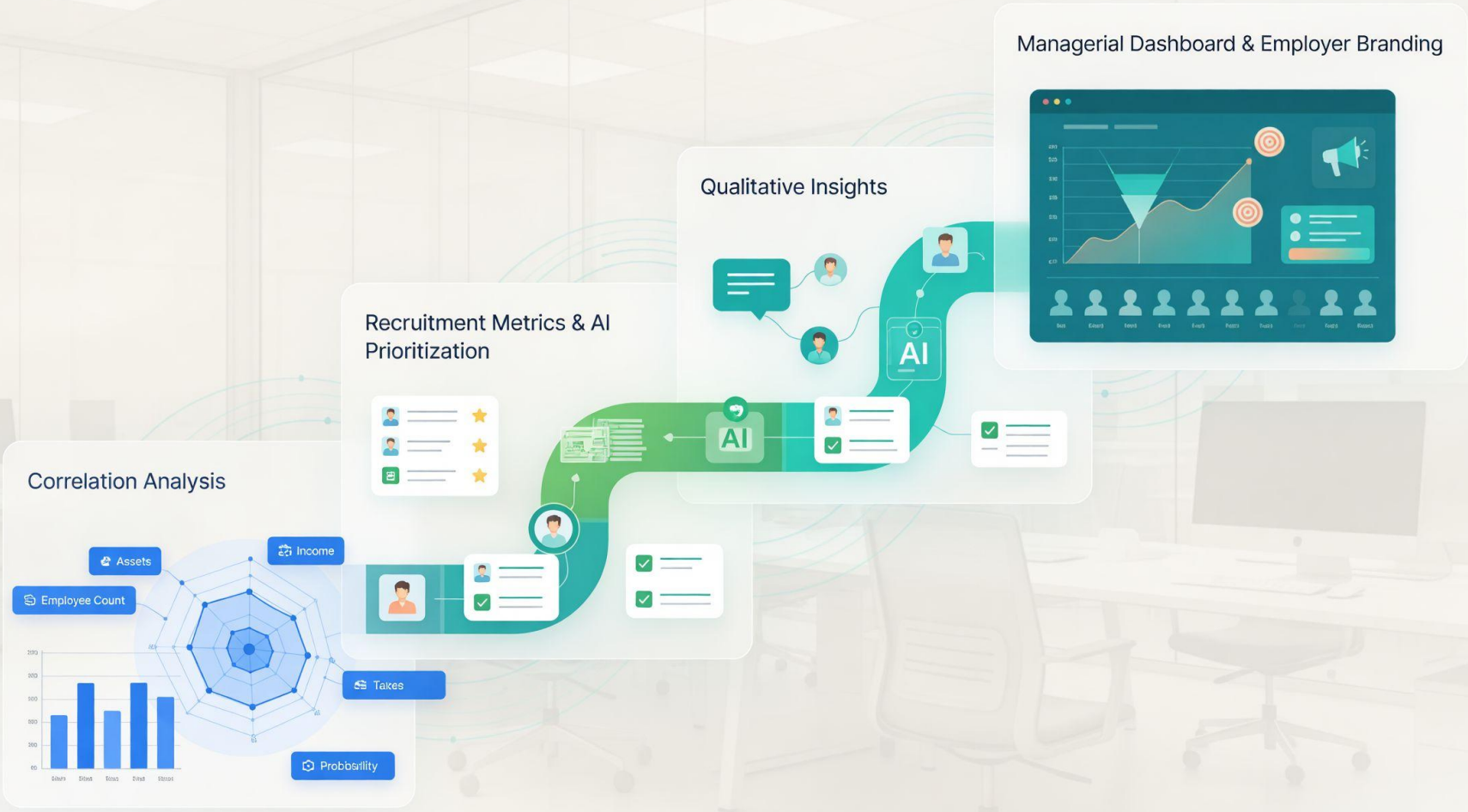
Use of Online Platforms and Social Media



Overview of Recruitment Channels

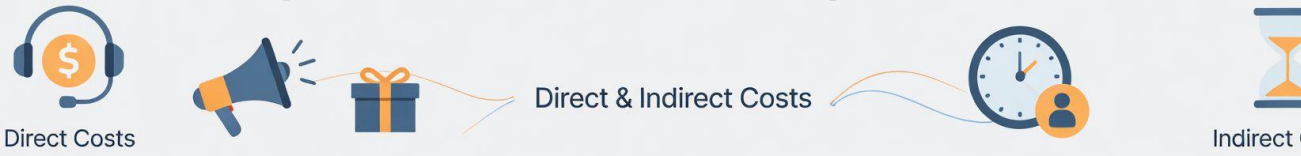


Data-driven Recruitment Strategies

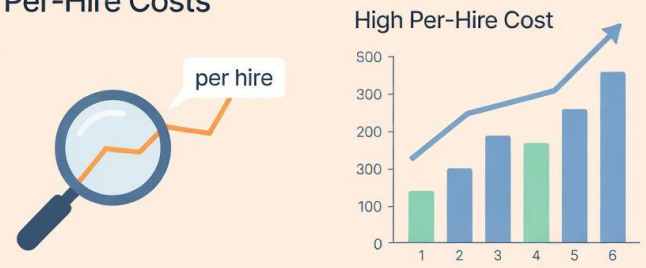


Cost Analysis of Talent Acquisition

Components of Talent Acquisition Costs



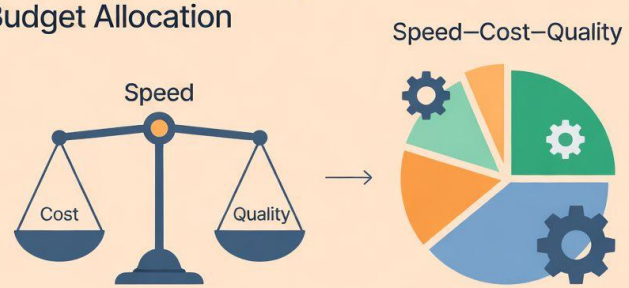
Challenges with High Per-Hire Costs



Embedded Recruiting Model as Cost-Effective Alternative



Trade-offs and Strategic Budget Allocation



Quantitative Cost per Hire Model

Cost per Hire = Total Recruitment Costs > Number of Hires



Employer Branding Techniques



Legal and Ethical Considerations in Recruitment



Role of Technology in Talent Acquisition



Chapter 3: Talent Selection Strategies for Technology-based Startup

Ir Prof Alan Lam, JP



Criteria for Talent Selection

Importance of Talent Selection

Aligning talent with innovation, execution & sustainability

Core Selection Criteria



Measurable Selection Metrics



Market Evidence of Criteria Impact



Evolving Hiring Practices



Multi-criteria Decision Making Methods



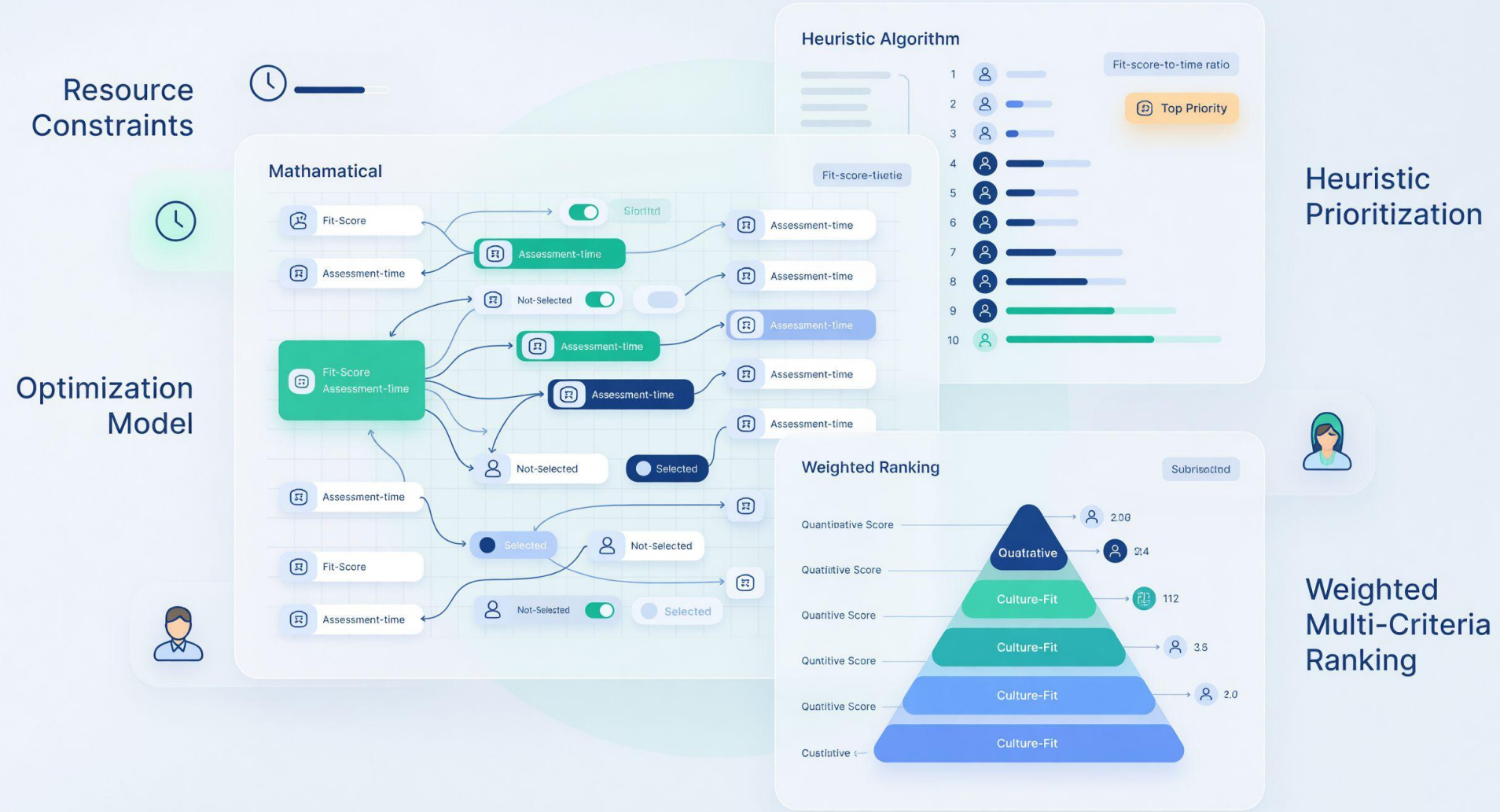
Behavioral and Technical Assessments



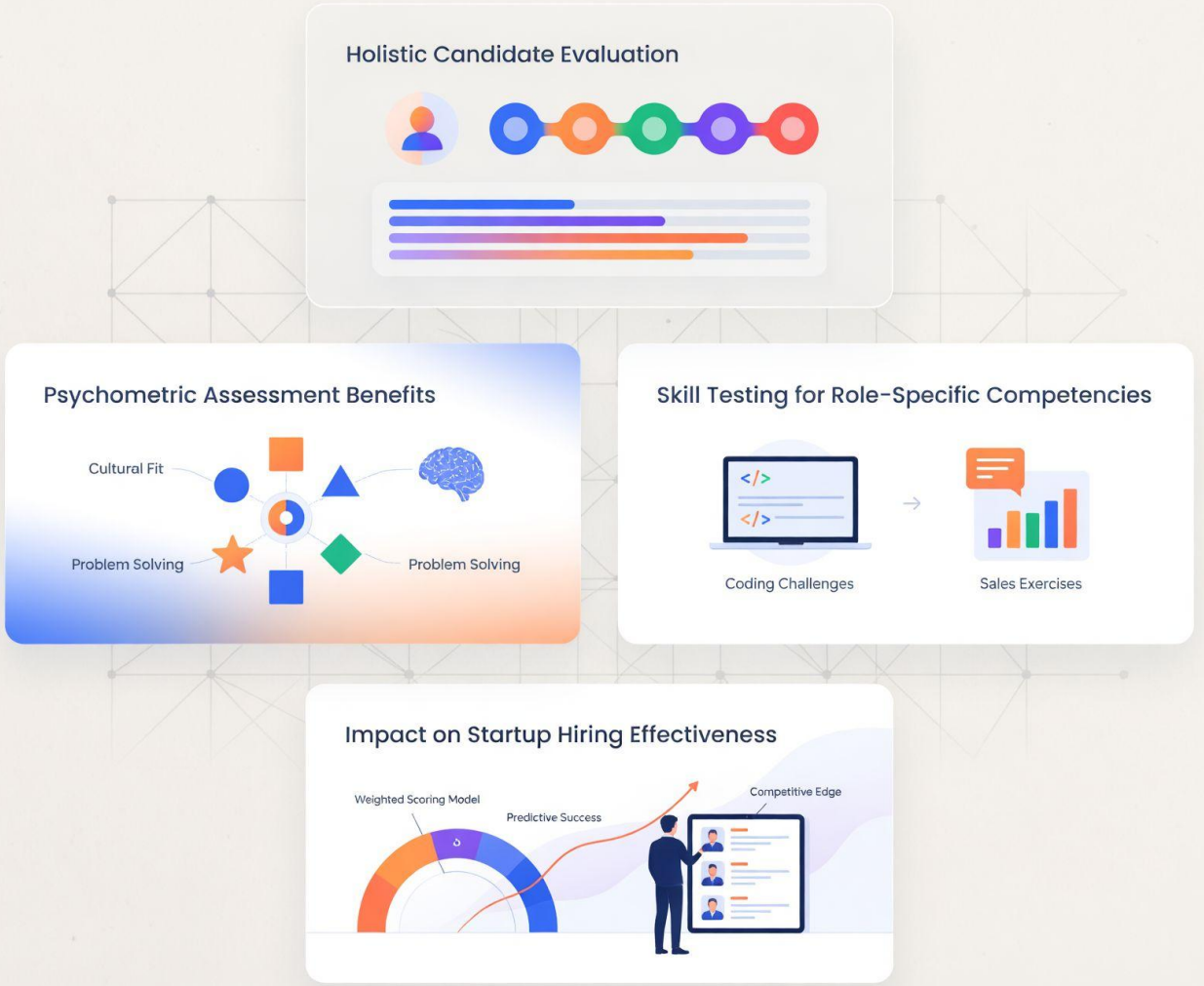
Statistical Methods in Candidate Screening



Optimization Models for Selection Processes



Psychometric and Skill Testing Integration



Utilizing Psychometrics in Selection

Role of Psychomertic Tests

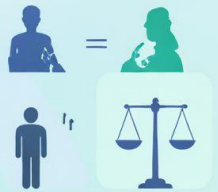
Personality, Cognition & Emotional Insight

Common Instruments



Big Five & Raven's Tests

Hiring Objectivity & Bias Reduction



Bias Reduction & Objective Selection

Integration with Quantitative Models

Enhanced Prediction Accuracy

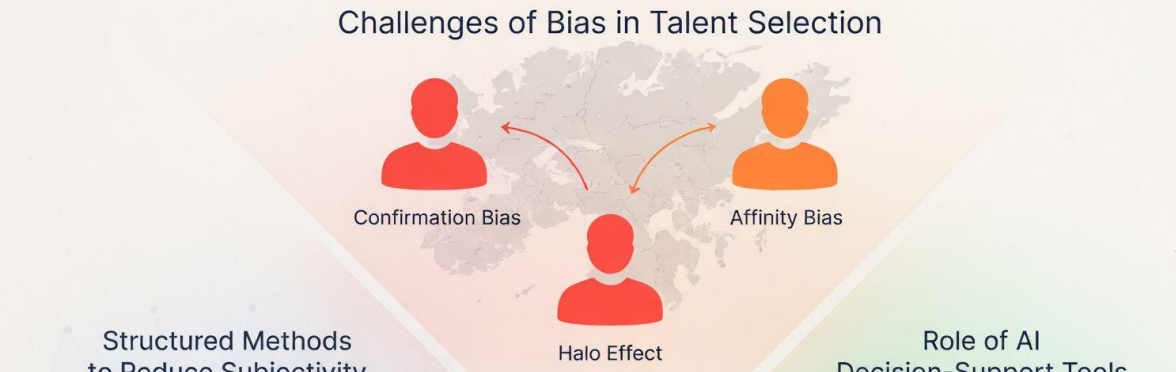


Balancing Cognitive Capacity & Team Cohesion

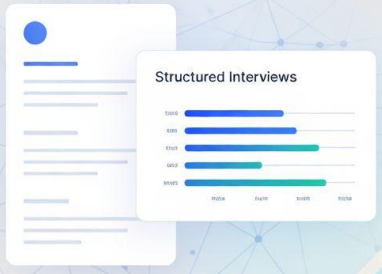


Cognitive–Collaborative Fit

Bias in Talent Selection and How to Mitigate



Structured Methods to Reduce Subjectivity



Role of AI Decision-Support Tools



Blind Resume Screening



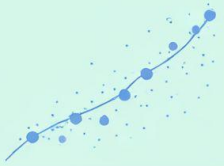
Data Analysis of Selection Outcomes

Metric Tracking for Feedback Loops



Correlation Analysis of Assessment Scores

Scores >80 → +20% Output



Data Visualization to Guide Adjustments

Data Visualization to Guide Adjustments



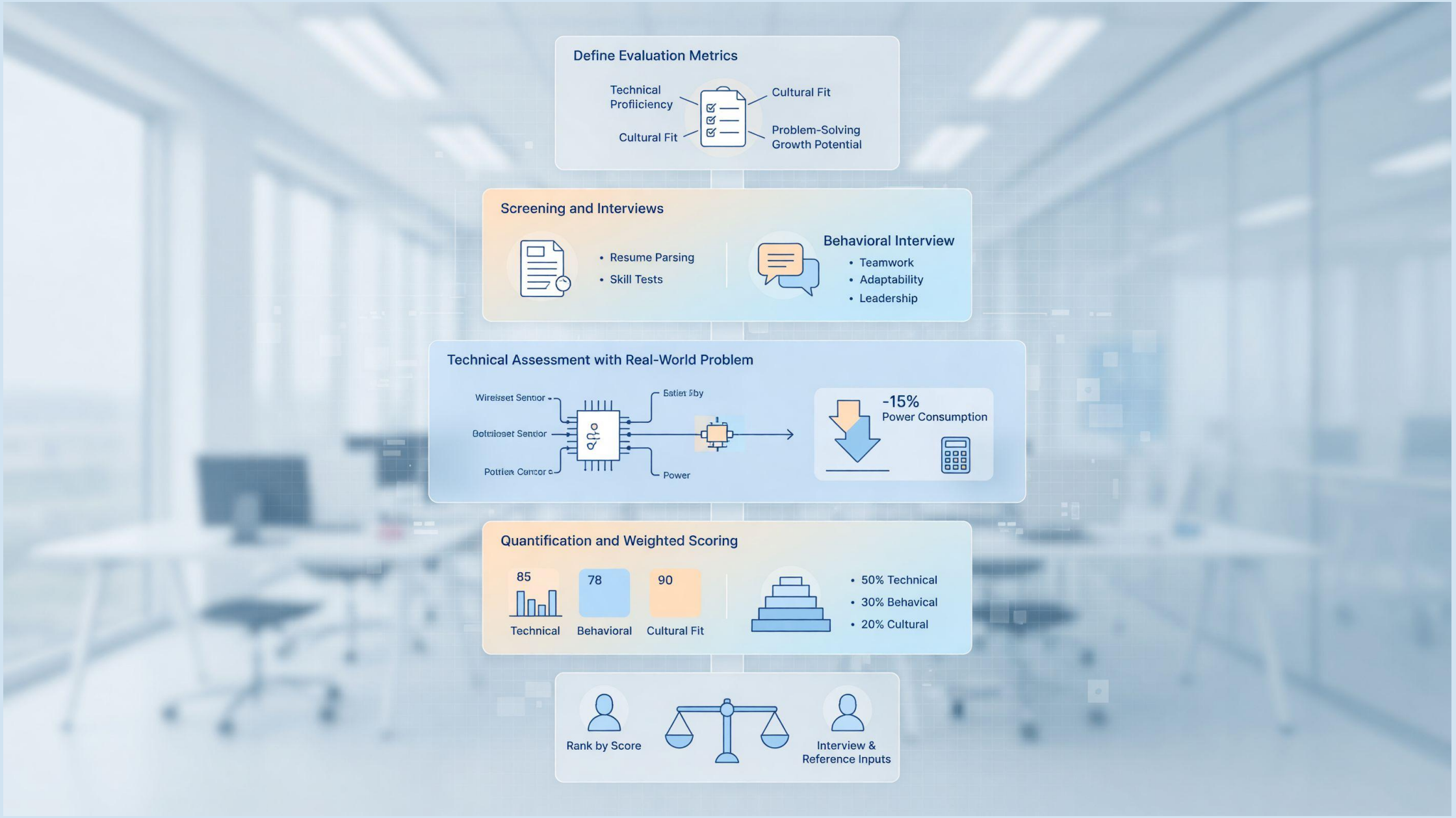


Statistical Testing to Validate Changes



Iterative Analysis for Business Alignment

Step-by-step Candidate Evaluation Examples



Real-world Selection Challenges

Market Competition and Time Pressure

- Intense engineer demand,
- Higher salary expectations,
- Short candidate windows



Bias and Subjectiviy in Cultural Fit Assessments



- Subjective evaluations,
- Risk of exclusion,
- Structured interviews.

Limitations of Technical Assessments



- Unrealistic scenarios
- Test vs. real work gap

Insufficient Historical Hiring Data



- Lack of past performance data
- Model calabration challenges

Tension Between Speed and Thoroughness



Hiring speed vs. evaluation depth

- Risks poor fit
- Delays progress

Adopting Flexible, Iterative Selection Methods

- Pilot small substets



- Rapid feedback integration

Chapter 4: Team Training Strategies for Startup

Ir Prof Alan Lam, JP



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Needs Assessment for Training



Designing Effective Training Modules

Alignment of Training with Startup Innovation Cycles



Customized, cycle-aligned modules

Georgetown Tech Ventures modular framework

- Customer Discovery
- Prototyping Support

Modular Design and Pedagogical Approach

Focused, experiential sessions



Workshops

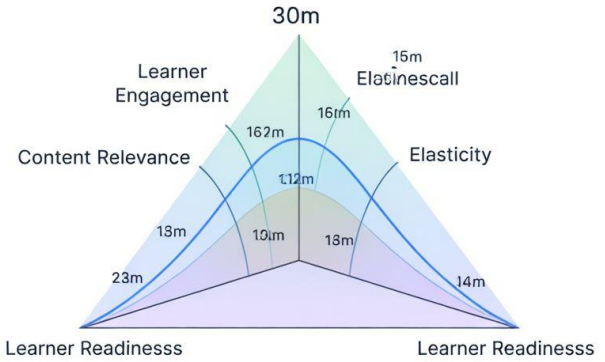


Role-playing



Peer review

Mathematical Model of Training Effectiveness



Sequenced Curriculum Framework

- Customer Feedback
- Innovation & Validation
- Tech Skills
- Team Collaboration
- Legal & IP Fundamentals

Quantitative Assessment of Training Impact

From Anecdote to Data-Driven Measurement



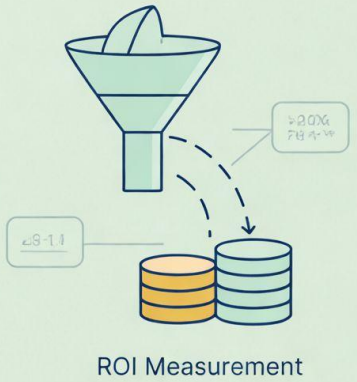
Key Performance Indicators



Analytical Tools



Financial Evaluation



ROI Measurement

Foundational Practices



baseline metrics



clear objectives

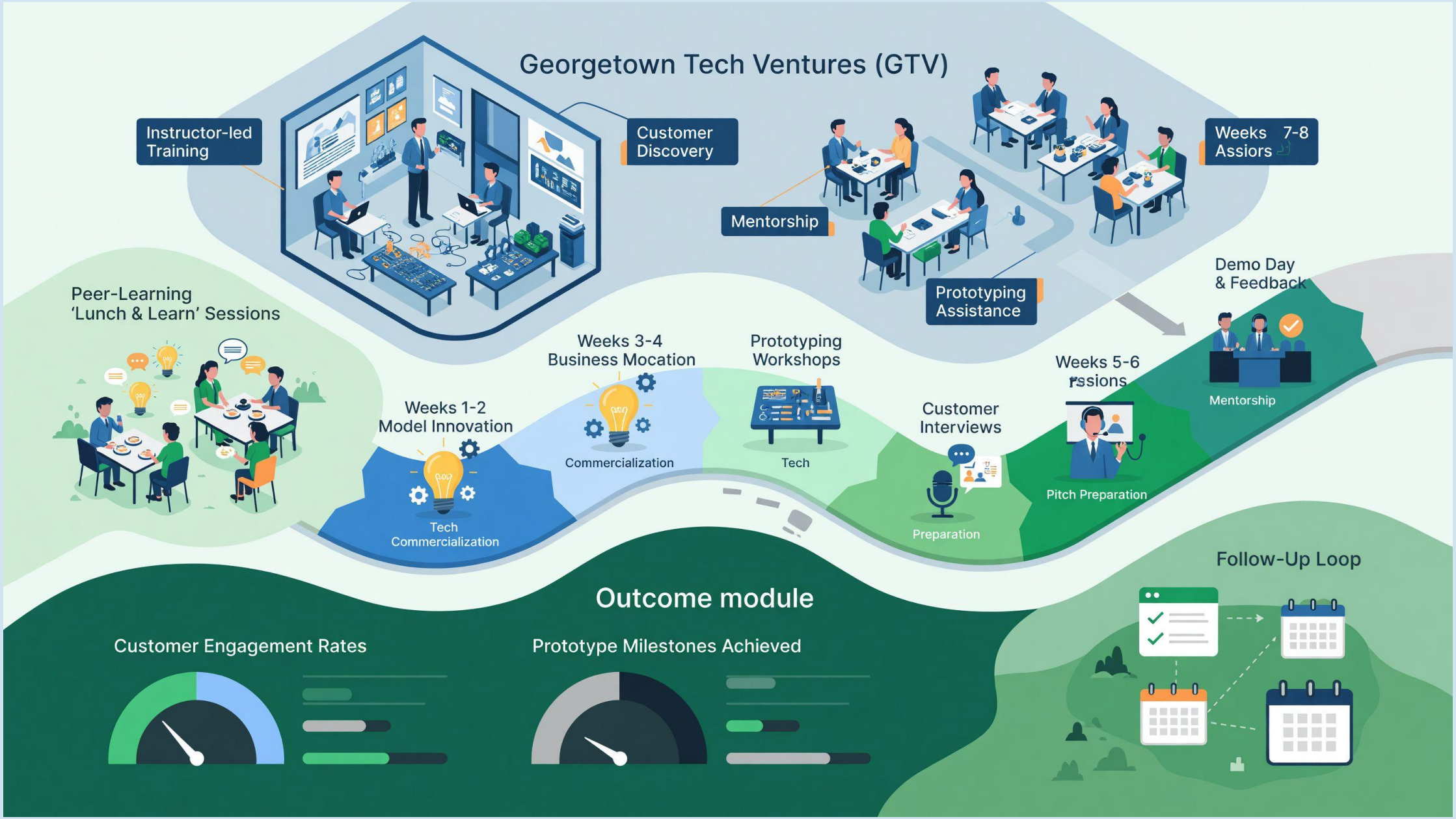


analytics tools

Cost-benefit Analysis of Team Training



Examples of Training Program Implementation



Examples of Successful Training Strategies

Customer Service Training

Supply Chain Logistics

Digital Payment Systems



"Mentorship and Experiential Learning"

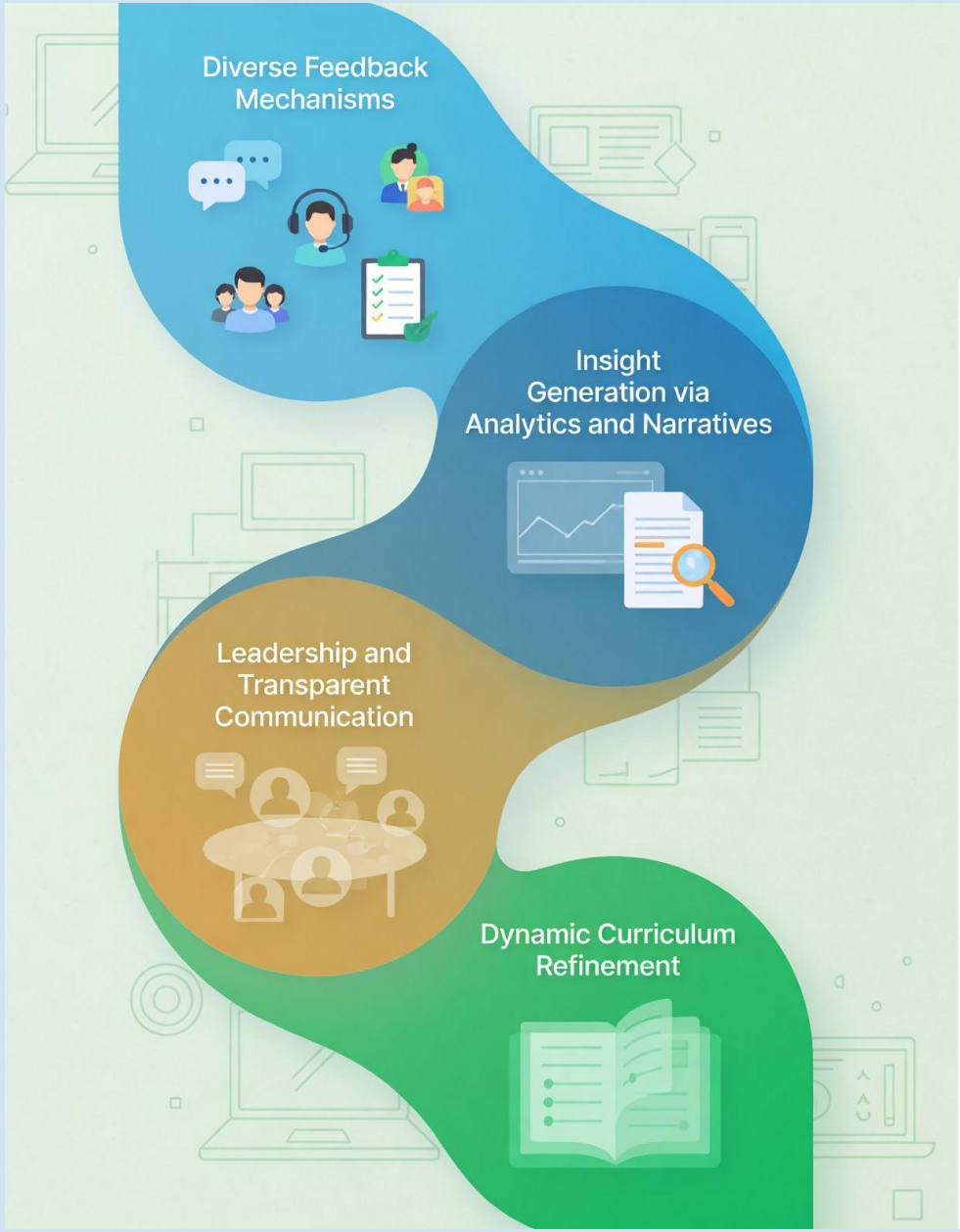


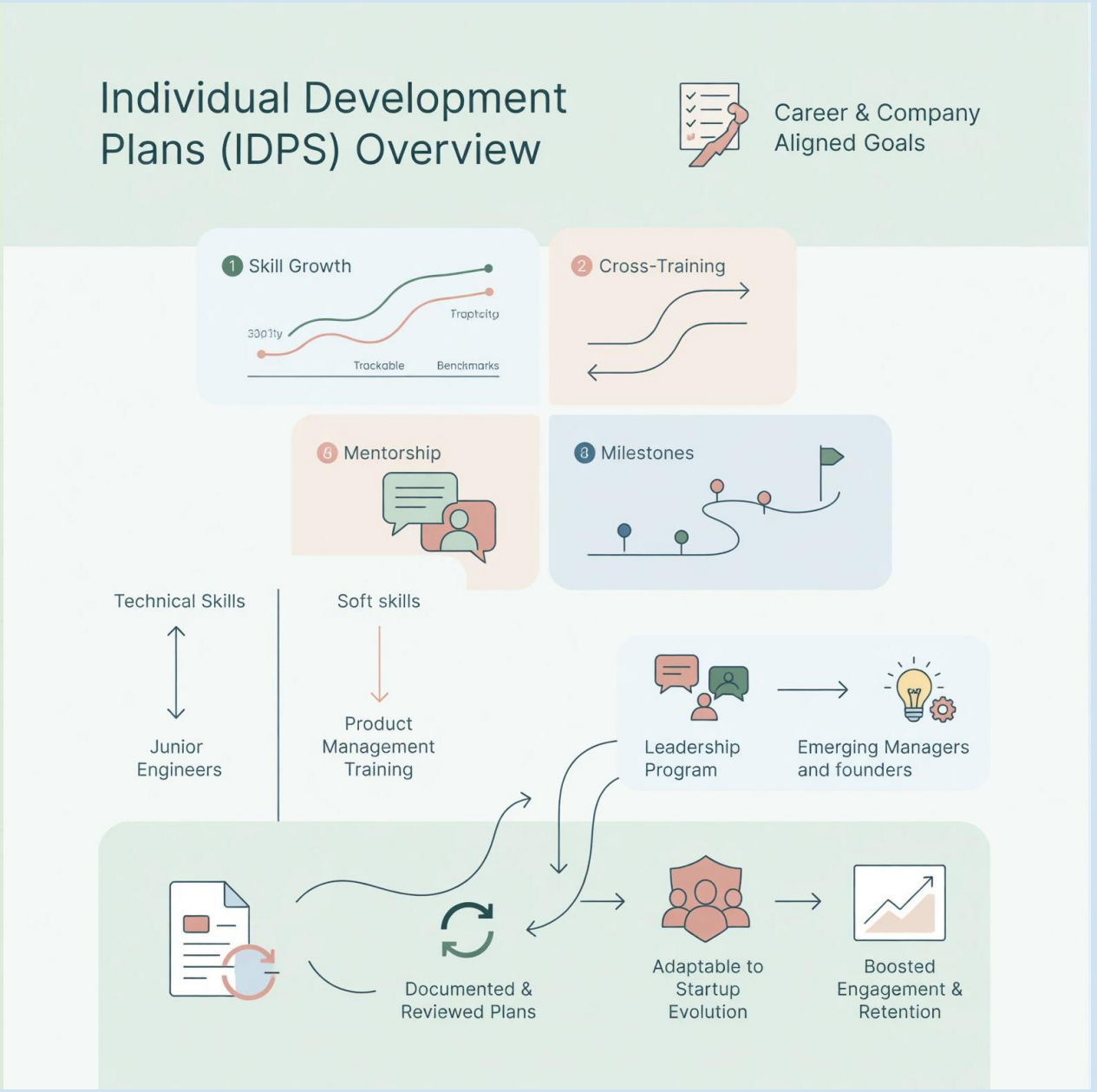
Innovation Culture

Adaptability

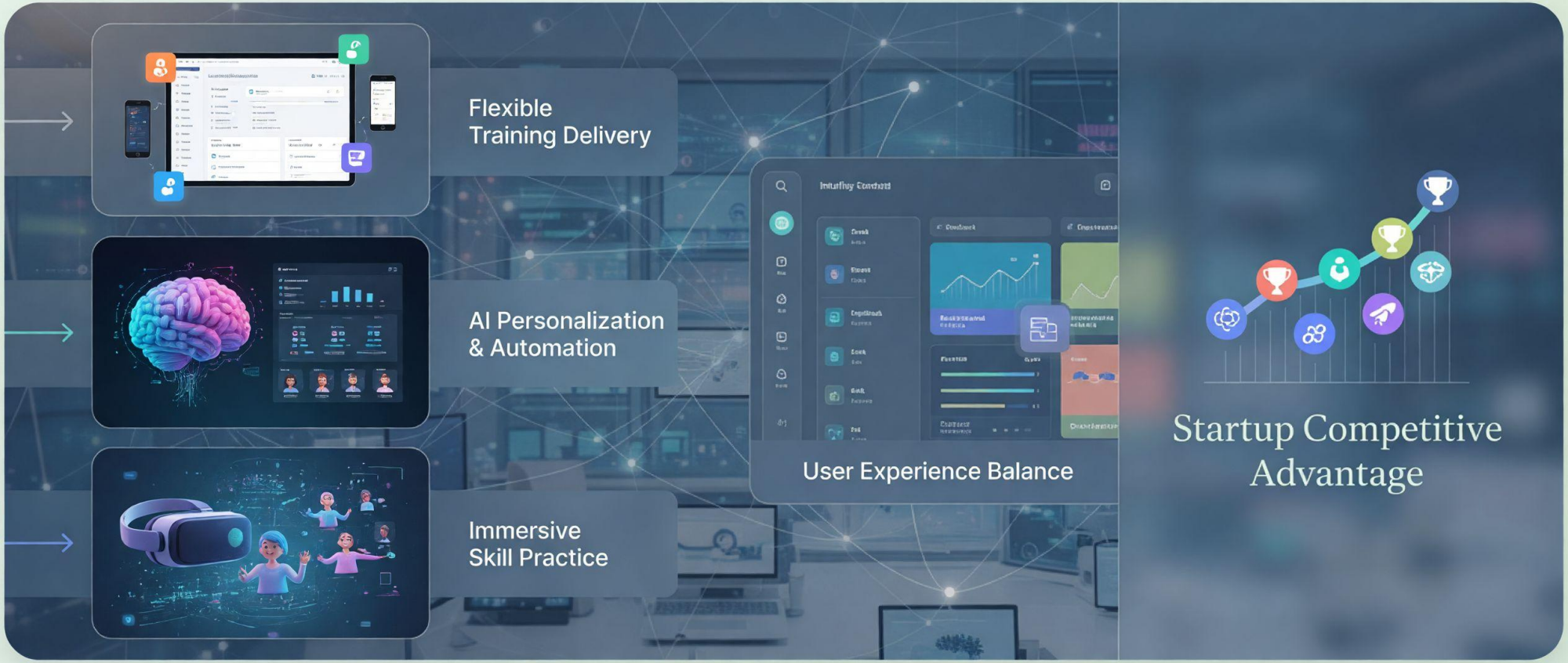
Proactive Problem-Solving

Employee Development Plans





Technology Utilization in Training Delivery



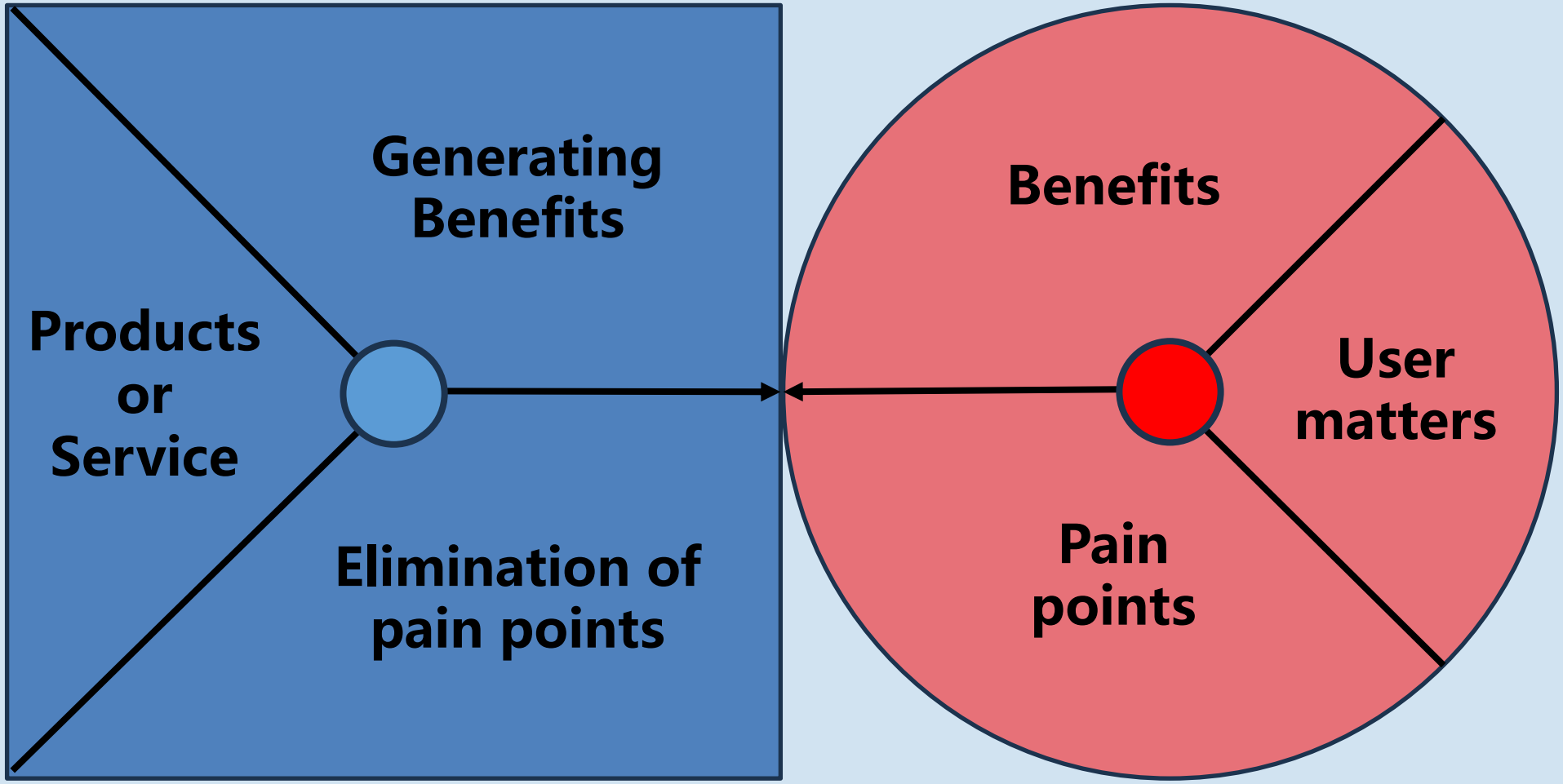
Chapter 5: Value Proposition of Startup

Ir Prof Alan Lam, JP



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Value proposition canvas



Innovative Business Ideas



https://youtu.be/Y_jJ1hslyd0

Value proposition canvas

Job-to-be-Done:
The target customer intends to use (through) the results

- **Work hard to complete or**
- **Problems that are struggling to solve or**
- **Strive to meet the needs**

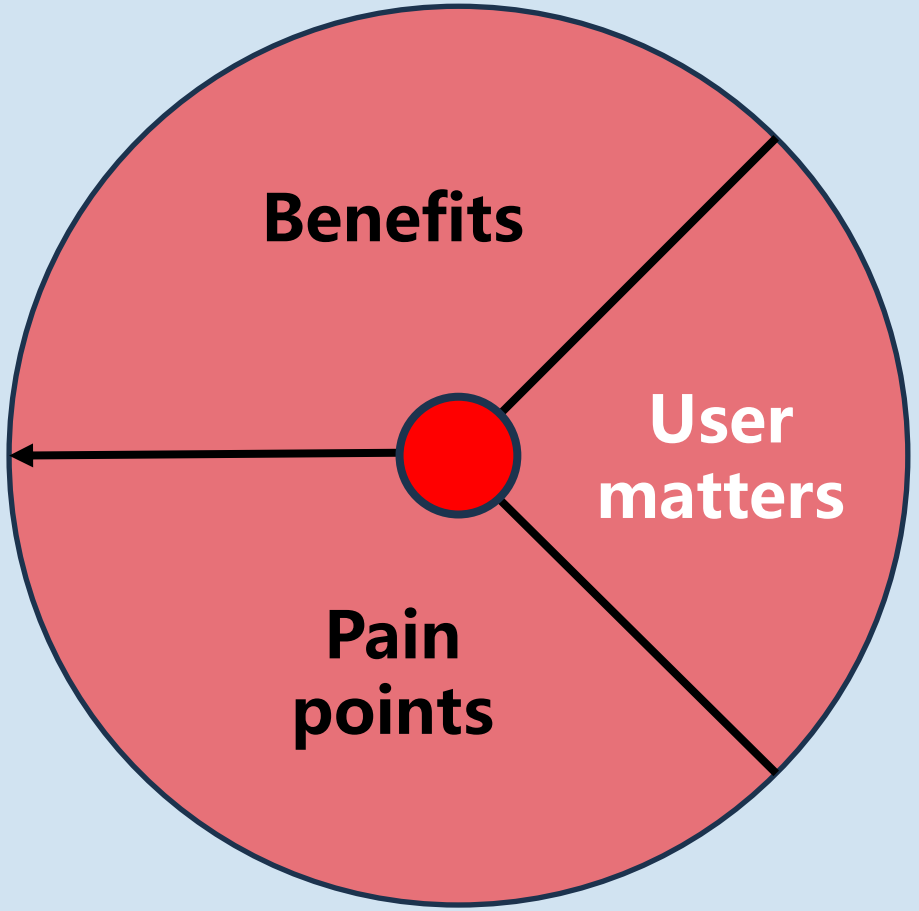
Significance:

- **The fundamental purpose and reason why users buy products, services, and solutions**

Types of User Matters:

- **Function**
- **Society**
- **Emotions**

VPC-RHS Spotlight on Users
It is carried out through market research, demand collection, brainstorming, etc



Value proposition canvas

Pain points (Pains):

- **The pain and dissatisfaction that users feel about the existing solution (or not using it).**

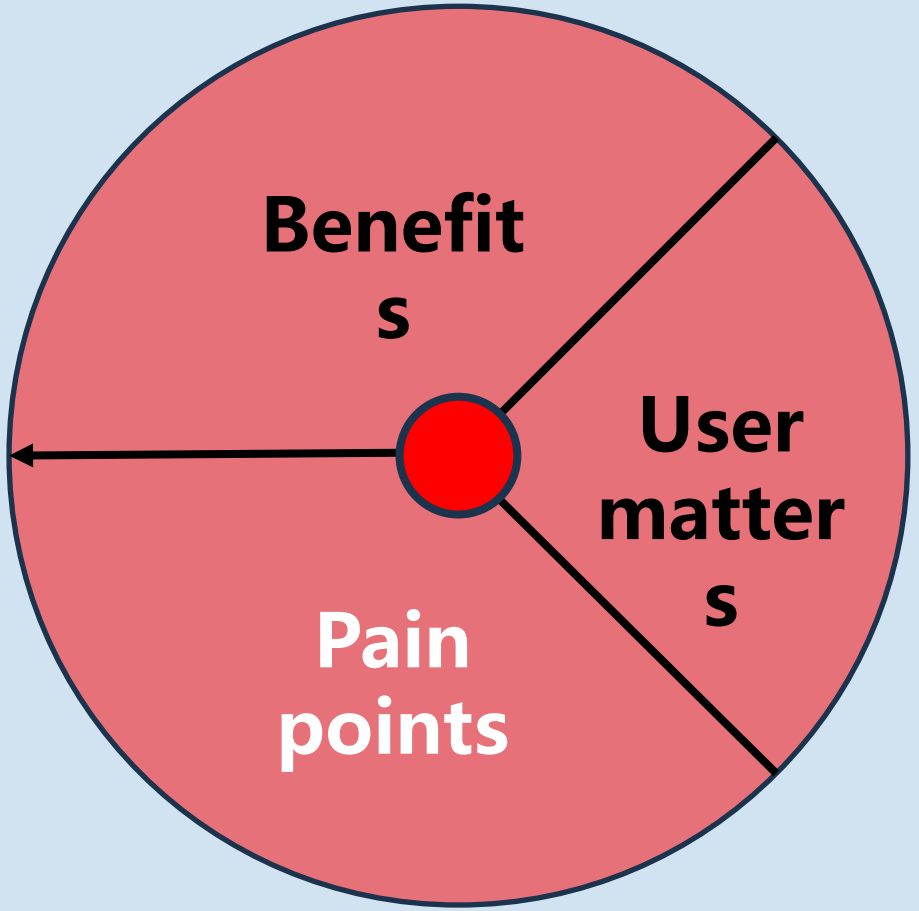
Includes:

- **The pain caused by imperfection**
- **Risks of using the current scheme**
- **Obvious sense of cost**
- **The current plan does not meet the needs**

Other pain points

- **Meaning: Subdivide the most important momentum for users to replace (or select) new technology paths (products).**

VPC-RHS Spotlight on Users
It is carried out through market research, demand collection, brainstorming, etc

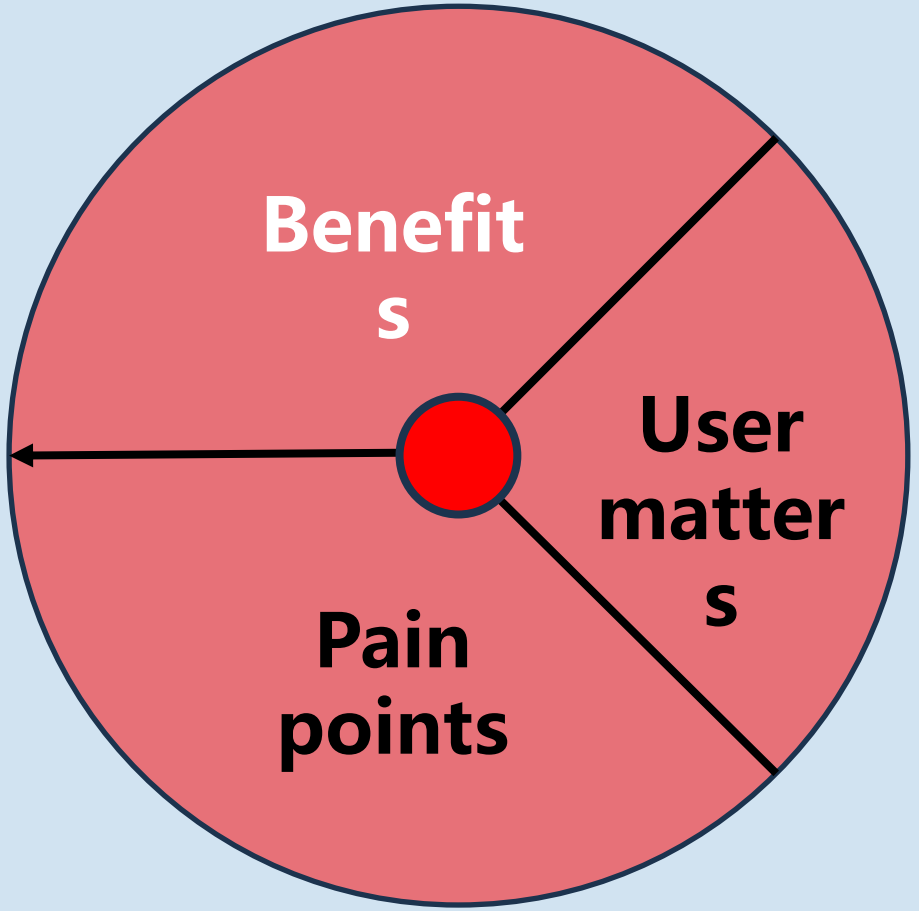


Value proposition canvas

Gains: The expected results or benefits of the user for the user matter, which may include what is or may not be provided by the current program.

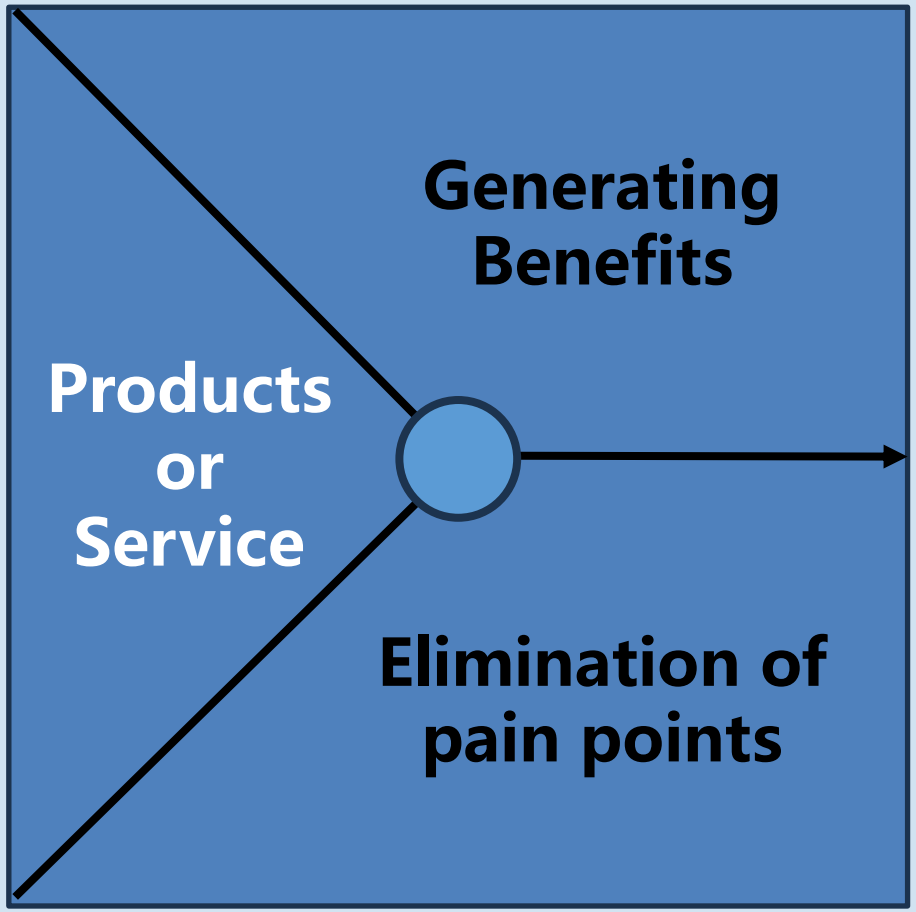
- Necessary benefits (basic needs, unacceptable if not met)
- Desired benefits (added value clearly expected by users)
- Desired benefits (potential value that users do not express but expect in their hearts)
- Unexpected benefits (surprise value that exceeds user expectations)

VPC-RHS Spotlight on Users
It is carried out through market research, demand collection, brainstorming, etc



Value proposition canvas

VPC-LHS focuses on "Technology (Products, Services)" Through technical contribution and effect dismantling and analysis, etc.

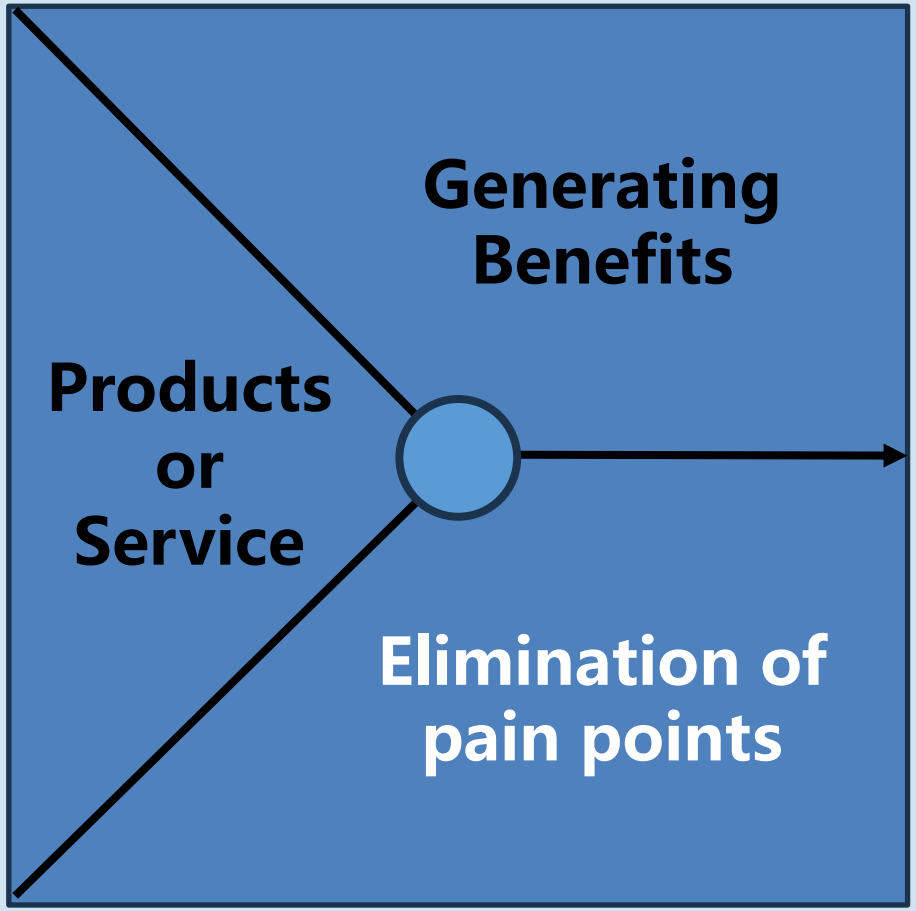


New technologies, new solutions, new projects

- A brief description of the technology (product, solution); Core application orientation (choose which option)
- List all product and service options based on new technologies and solutions;

Value proposition canvas

VPC-LHS focuses on "Technology (Products, Services)" Through technical contribution and effect dismantling and analysis, etc.



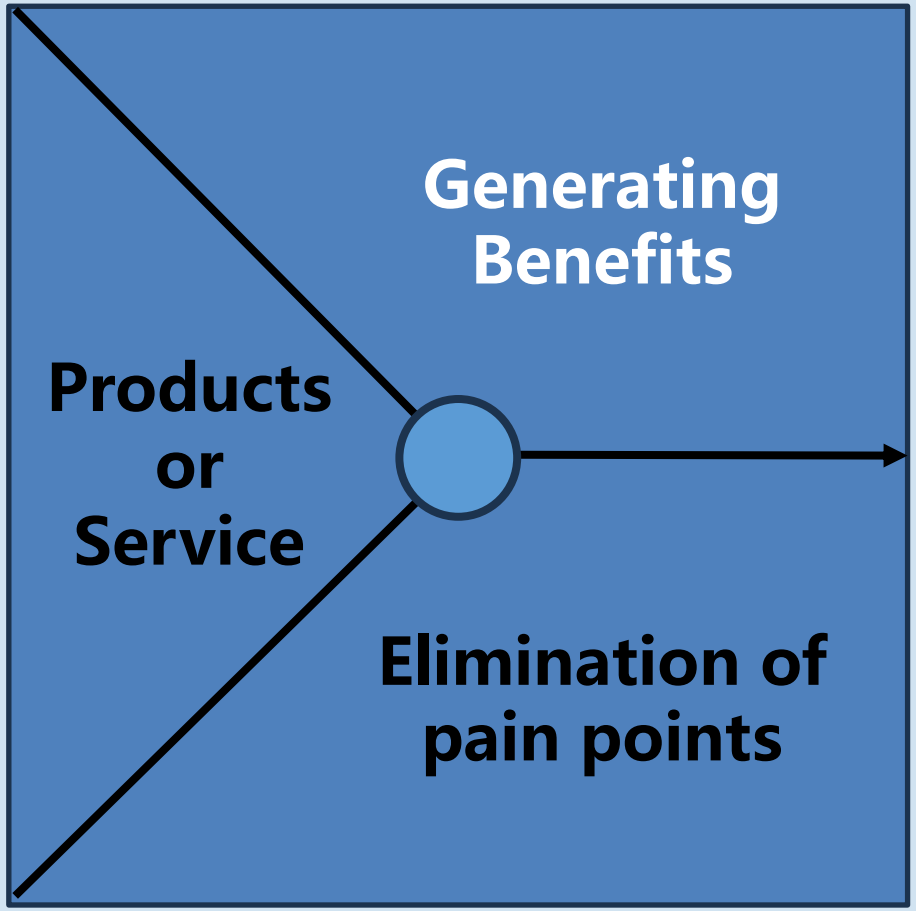
Elimination of pain points

New technologies and new solutions can produce:

- Elimination or change of pain points (may decrease or increase)
  It can be divided into:
  - Eliminated (mitigated)
  - Nothing has changed
  - New (more serious)
- Excellent value propositions focus on the most important needs of customers, especially the most prominent pain points of mainstream users
- Optional value propositions focus on a specific customer need and a specific customer segment

Value proposition canvas

VPC-LHS focuses on "Technology (Products, Services)" Through technical contribution and effect dismantling and analysis, etc.



Benefits

New technologies and new solutions can produce:

- **New benefit or change in benefit (may increase or decrease);**
- **The generation of benefits can be analyzed structurally according to necessity, expectation, desire, accident, etc.;**
- **Benefit-generating scenarios do not need to identify or meet every need identified in the user's matter;**
- **In practice, it is necessary to think about the source and reliability of relevant "pain point elimination" information.**

Value proposition canvas

- The value proposition canvas mainly tests the preliminary desirability of technology (product, service);
- The information on the right side of the value proposition canvas (RHS) often comes from market research, which needs to be objective and truthful, and often cannot be adapted at will. The content of the left semicircle (LHS) should be changed to match the right (RHS) mainly through technical (product, service) positioning, selection, improvement, etc.
- The value proposition is relative to the existing solution being used; If two customers use two different existing solutions (resulting in different RHS, different matching situations), two different VPCs need to be mapped. As a result, the value proposition of the final choice tends to vary.
- One technology (service, company) may not solve all the pain and benefits, so it may be necessary to determine which pains/benefits to prioritize.
- Trade-offs: While increasing some benefits, some new pain points may be introduced; Or when alleviating some pain points, it may also reduce some benefits.

Chapter 6: Successful Example: Alibaba for Successful Team Formation and Training

Ir Prof Alan Lam, JP



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Alibaba’s Team Formation Strategy



Talent Acquisition and Selection at Alibaba



Training and Development Practices

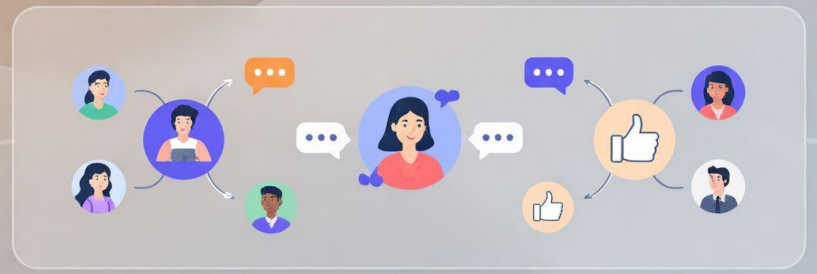
Integrated Training Approach

Classroom learning → On-the-job training → Real-time feedback

Real Marketplace Challenges







Empathy & Strategic Vision



Organizational Culture and Team Dynamics

Leadership & Core Cultural Values

- Customer Obsession,
- Teamwork
- Perseverance
- Resilience



Communication & Psychological Safety



- Open Communication
- Flattened Bureaucracy
- Creativity & Risk-Taking

Diversity & Cross-Functional Teams

- Varied Perspectives
- Enhanced Innovation

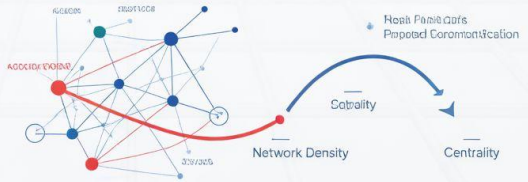


Work Hard, Work Smart

- Work Hard, Accountability
- Shared Accountability
- Attspetuiert



Quantitative Team Effectiveness



Quantitative Analysis of Alibaba's Growth



Challenges Faced and Solutions Applied



Lessons Learned from Alibaba's Example



In-Class Discussion:

- Please based on the today's lecture to summarize what did you learn.
- Work out your team formation and development plan
- Based on your project to work out the VPC
- Make one Slide about Team for Execution based on the value proposition that can be provided by the team.

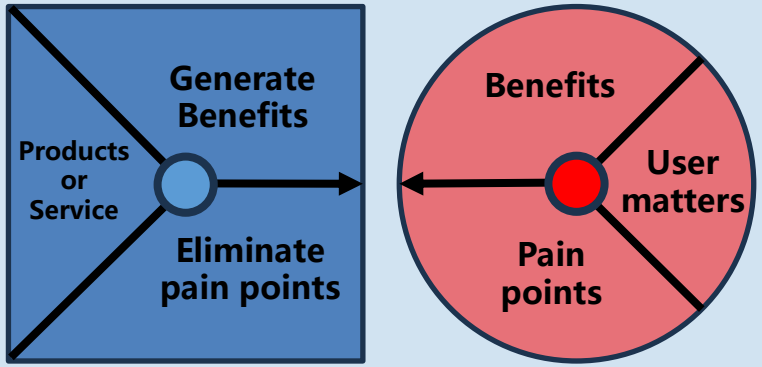


Value proposition canvas

Generating Benefits

Benefits

Products or services



User matters

Elimination of pain points

Pain points

Reference:

- Scully, D. (2020, August 7). *The 5 Stages of Team Development*. Teamwork: https://www.teamwork.com/blog/the-5-stages-of-team-development-what-you-need-to-know/
- Stein, J. *Using the Stages of Team Development*. Human Resources, Massachusetts Institute of Technology: https://hr.mit.edu/learning-topics/teams/articles/stages-development



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Adjunct Professor

End of Presentation
Thank You